cross their borders not only without pre-obtained visas, but often even without any identification and without knowing where they were heading to.

So history did not end, after all. It was being created in a most challenging way. There was no time for complacency anymore:[128] the Russian annexation of Crimea (apparently a prelude for 2022's full-scale invasion), the 2015 refugee crisis, Brexit in 2016 and Trump in America attested to that. Something had to be done. Chancellor Merkel struck a deal with Turkey, 'a slightly dirty deal that arguably replicated some of the controls of freedom of movement demanded by the likes of Orbán, without fully acknowledging it.'[129] The gates of Europe were open to prove its high values. Germans, in particular, still offered a noble example of a welcoming society.

Hungary and the rest of Central Europe too felt that the end of history was nowhere near, even if their way of thinking was different. First, there was an objection to the procedure by which the decision on redistribution was taken within the EU. (It was later challenged unsuccessfully in the EU court, though the discussion on widening the scope of the so-called quality majority vote continues.) There was also a practical argument: how on earth could one prevent migrants or refugees from leaving, at the earliest opportunity, say, Slovakia, and heading for Germany or Sweden. In the eyes of Central Europeans, Europe appeared naive, weak, unable to deal with the migration wave, certainly unable to stop it and to effectively police its borders. This must have, they reckoned, something to do with Western Europe's philosophical underpinning: 'Central Europe's fearmongering populists interpreted the refugee crisis as a conclusive evidence that liberalism has weakened the capacity of nations to defend themselves in a hostile world.'[130] In another place, Krastev concludes: 'It was liberalism's failure to address the migration problem, rather than economic crisis or rising inequality, that explains the public turn against it.'[131]

But more important, even if much more tacit, was, as already suggested, the argument of not being ready for culturally different or distant migrants. For sure, former Eastern bloc nations had, even during the Communist time, some contact with comrades from friendly third-world countries. But these were mostly students and experts on a mission of limited duration. (An interesting exception is the Vietnamese community in the Czech Republic